

A character starts with one dot in the Alchemy that corresponds to her Fortune — Wood, Fire, Earth, Metal, or Water. The player may place three additional dots in this or other Alchemies in any manner she chooses, though none may rise above three dots and none of these dots may be placed in Nei Tan (though this can be purchased with freebie points).

Temper

A Hsien's Temper reflects her nature: two forces balanced against the other.

Yin Chi and Yang Chi

Hsien have Chi values between 1 and 5, representing her internal store of both Yin and Yang Chi. Aside from determining which of her Legacies is ascendant, it is essential for Wu Tan—higher Chi means greater facility with elemental alchemy. Kwannon-jin determines the starting Chi values:

Kith	Yin	Yang
Chu Jung, Nyan	1	3
Suijen, Heng Po	3	1
Komuko, Hanumen	2	2
Chu-ih-yu, Tanuki	2	1*
Hou-chi, Fu-hsi	1	2*

* The Hsien may place one dot in either Yin or Yang, as she desires.

Tao

Tao reflects the Hsien's ability to internalize balance between Yin and Yang, and is not a purchased Temper. It always equals the average of her Yin and Yang Chi.

Yugen

Yugen is a special kind of Chi generated by mortal reverence and celebration. It typically gathers in dragon nests, and may be directly absorbed by the Hsien at festivals and other religious observances. A Hsien's maximum Yugen is equal to twice the sum of her Yin and Yang Chi values, though a Jade Talisman may also be used to store Yugen.

Willpower

All characters begin play with four dots of Willpower.

Merits, Flaws, and Freebie Points

Many Merits and Flaws don't make sense for Shinma because they are unlike the Kithain in so many ways. Surreal Quality, Iron Allergy, Chimerical Magnet, Faerie Eternity, Poetic Heart, Cleared Mists, Chimerical Disability, Seeming's Blessing, Slipped Seeming, and Sidhe's Curse are not appropriate for Hsien characters.

Freebie Points

Traits	Cost
Abilities	2
Attributes	5
Backgrounds	1
Chi	4
Merits	Variable
Willpower	2
Wu Tan	5

Experience Points

Traits	Cost
Attributes	Current Rating x4
New Abilities	3
Abilities	Current Rating x2
Willpower	Current Rating x2
Wu Tan	Current Rating x5
New Wu Tan	6
Chi	Current Rating x3

New Traits

Hsien use the following traits, some of which replace those inapplicable to the Shinma, others of which provide additional dimensions inapplicable to changelings.

Shentao

Much like Kenning, which it replaces, Shentao represents the innate magical sense common to the Shinma. It allows them to sense each other, dragon nests, and dragon lines, and to detect those who hunt them. Shentao may be used to assess changelings at a +2 difficulty. Kithain suffer a similar difficulty when using Kenning on Shinma.

- ☉ **Novice:** You feel it when you wake up after having slept on a dragon line.
 - ☉☉ **Practiced:** You have no trouble locating dragon nests or True Jade.
 - ☉☉☉ **Competent:** You're able to reliably spot other Hsien, regardless of whether they want to be found.
 - ☉☉☉☉ **Expert:** You make a pastime of people watching and picking out which people are mortals and which very much aren't.
 - ☉☉☉☉☉ **Master:** Nothing is hidden.
- Possessed by:** Hsien, other shen, very aware mortals.
- Specialties:** Dragon Nests, Dragon Lines, Hsien, Hengeyokai, Keui-jin, Shih, Chi'n Ta, True Jade, Ghosts, Spirits, Demons.